Andrea Novellis

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Academic Positions

07/2026–09/2026 **Research Associate**, *University of Naples "L'Orientale"*, Naples (Italy)
ITALIM project. Research on the international politics of food security, food-related political vulnerability, and conflict in the Middle East and North Africa.

10/2024–10/2025 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *University of Naples "L'Orientale"*, Naples (Italy)
Project: RAP-RISK (Political Risk Measurement: Risks and Opportunities). Research on early warning systems, crisis recognition failures, and political risk analysis. Case studies: Sri Lanka, Israel, Palestine.

10/2019–05/2024 **Doctoral Researcher**, *University of Milan*, Milan (Italy)
PhD in Political Science. Research on ethnic conflict, rebel political institutions, and governance in NE Syria, Sri Lanka, and Nepal. Fieldwork in Turkey, KRI-Iraq, Sri Lanka. Training in qualitative and quantitative methods.

Research Affiliations

09/2026–11/2026 **Visiting Postdoctoral Researcher**, *Institute of Federalism, University of Fribourg*, Fribourg (Switzerland)
University of Fribourg Scholarship; host: Prof. Eva Maria Belser.

2026– **Associated Member**, *Center on the International Politics of Food Security (CIPFS)*, Interuniversity research centre, University of Pavia (Italy)

2025–2026 **Fellow**, *Civil War Paths – Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil Wars*, University of York (UK)

Consulting & Professional Experience

07/2025 **Consultant**, *ACAPS*, Switzerland / Remote
Provided expert review and recommendations on a report on humanitarian risk in Syria.

11/2024–03/2025 **Consultant**, *National Peace Council*, Colombo (Sri Lanka)
Staff training on research methods.

08/2023–05/2025 **Consultant**, *Arci (NGO)*, Italy / Remote
Country of Origin Information (COI) research; staff training on asylum procedures and socio-political context.

02/2021–07/2022 **Researcher & Consultant**, *Operazione Colomba – Nonviolent Peace Corps*, Italy / Remote
Research on rebel groups and human rights in North-East Syria.

Teaching

2026 **Course Instructor**, *Bandaranaike Centre for International Studies (BCIS)*, Colombo (Sri Lanka)
Short course: *Rethinking Peace, Conflict, and the Post-Liberal Order*.

2022–2023 **Teaching Assistant, MA course "Global Geopolitics"**, *University of Milan*, Milan (Italy)

Education

2024 **PhD in Political Studies**, *University of Milan*, Italy
Dissertation: *Why Fight When You Can Rule Together? Rebel Power-Sharing During Civil Wars*.

2014–2017 **MA in Comparative International Relations**, *Ca' Foscari University of Venice*, Italy
Final grade: 110/110 *cum laude*. Visiting Graduate Student, University of Toronto (2016–2017). Erasmus+, Boğaziçi University (2015–2016).

Grants

2026 MEDKLIMA: *Sicurezza alimentare, clima e instabilità politica nel Mediterraneo allargato: orientamenti per il Piano Mattei in Africa*, Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation (MAECI)
Co-author of successful competitive proposal; named research-team member. University of Naples "L'Orientale" lead institution; project on climate pressure, food security, political instability, and conflict in the wider Mediterranean.

2026 MAECI Study and Research Mission Grant, Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation
Awarded for invited academic activities at the Bandaranaike Centre for International Studies, Colombo (Sri Lanka).

2025–2026 ITALIM: Italy and the International Politics of Food Security, Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MAECI)
Principal proposal writer; awarded competitive inter-university research grant.

Publications

2026 Hanau Santini, Ruth, and Andrea Novellis. "Paradigm Lock-In and Strategic Surprise: Explaining Israel's October 7 Intelligence Failure." *Middle East Policy*.

Conditional acceptance Novellis, Andrea. "Early Warning Failure in Sri Lanka: Institutional Knowledge Filters and the 2022 Polycrisis." *Review of International Studies*.

2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Programmatic Incompatibility: Ideology, Trust and the Limits of Rebel Cooperation Among Syria's Kurdish Actors." *Civil Wars*.

2026 Corradi, Edoardo, and Andrea Novellis. "Earning, Allocating, Providing: The Financial and Budget Management of the Democratic Autonomous Administration of North and East Syria." *Civil Wars*.

2026 Novellis, Andrea. "The Divided Self: How Ideological Compartmentalization Drives Rebel-to-Party Success in Sri Lanka." *Democratization*.

2025 Novellis, Andrea, and Davide Grasso. "Introduction – Exploring the Kurdish Movement: Power Relations, Historical Dynamics and Theoretical Perspectives." *Partecipazione e Conflitto* 18(2): 384–394.

2018 Novellis, Andrea. "The Rise of Feminism in the PKK." *Zanj: The Journal of Critical Global South Studies*.

2018 Novellis, Andrea. "An Alternative to Nationalism: The Kurdish Movement in Turkey." *Occhialì. Rivista sul Mediterraneo islamico*.

Dissertation

2024 Novellis, Andrea. *Why Fight When You Can Rule Together? Rebel Power-Sharing During Civil Wars*. PhD diss., University of Milan.

Books / chapters

2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Syria: Food Security and Stability in the Post-Assad Transition." In Ruth Hanau Santini, ed., *Food Sovereignty and Food Security: The Increasing Weaponisation of Food*, 105–124. Naples: UniorPress.

2025 Novellis, Andrea. "Le Relazioni Esterne del DAANES nell'Interregno Siriano" ["The External Relations of DAANES in the Syrian Interregnum"]. In *La guerra civile siriana*. Rome: Carocci.

Research reports and policy papers

2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Early Warning and Sri Lanka's Economic Crisis." In Ruth Hanau Santini, Andrea Novellis, Rajni Gamage, and Devyani Chaturvedi, eds., *Humanitarianism, Development Assistance, Early Warning and Political Violence in South Asia*. *ISAS Special Report* 37.

Editorial Work

2026– Co-editor, Special Issue "Informality and Global Political Orders: Mechanisms of Governance Across States, Conflicts, and Diplomacy", *Cambridge Review of International Affairs*, forthcoming; co-editor, with Ruth Hanau Santini, Rajni Gamage, and Devyani Chaturvedi, *Humanitarianism, Development Assistance, Early Warning and Political Violence in South Asia*, *ISAS Special Report* 37, Institute of South Asian Studies, National University of Singapore.

2025– Member, Academic Advisory Board, *Vienna Kurdish Studies Yearbook*.

2025 Co-editor, Special Issue "Exploring the Kurdish Movement: Power Relations, Historical Dynamics and Theoretical Perspectives". *Partecipazione e Conflitto* 18(2).

Conference Organization

05/2026 Workshop *Food Security and Political Power in and beyond the MENA Region*, University of Naples "L'Orientale", Naples (Italy), 12 May 2026.

03/2026 *RISC Study Days*, Italian Kurdish Studies Network (RISC), University of Turin, Italy. International conference on Kurdish studies.

09/2023 *The Kurds and the Others*, University of Salento, Lecce (Italy). Co-organizer of the international conference "The Kurds and the Others", University of Salento, 28–29 Sep 2023.

Selected Conference Panel Chair

2025 Panel: "Beyond Sectarianism: Regional Politics and Conflict Realignments in the Middle East", SISP Conference, Naples (Italy), 4–6 Sep 2025.

2024 Panel: "Turkey Between the Past and Today's World. Who's and How's the Other?" SeSaMO Conference, University of Cagliari, 26 Sep 2024.

2024 Panel: "The Politics of Stabilisation and State Building", Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Edinburgh, 4–6 Sep 2024.

2022 Webinar: "Reflectivity and Research Ethics in Conflict Areas. Field Experiences from Kurdistan", SeSaMO Webinar Series "Research and the Middle East", 14 Dec 2022.

2022 Panel: "Kurdish Rojava, Autonomous Administration of North East Syria: propaganda or successful institutional experiment?", SeSaMO Conference, University of Naples L'Orientale, 22–24 Jun 2022.

Selected Conference Presentations and Workshops

09/2026 "Selective Violence after Rebel Victory: Armed-Order Consolidation in Post-Assad Syria, December 2024–September 2026", Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Glasgow, Glasgow (UK), 10 Sep 2026.

09/2026 "Conflict Termination and Authoritarian Opposition Management in Turkey", SISP Conference, University of Trento, Trento (Italy), 4 Sep 2026.

09/2026 "Stateness between Despotic and Infrastructural Power in the Post-2011 UAE, KSA and Türkiye: Authoritarian Infrastructural Power", SISP Conference, University of Trento, Trento (Italy), 4 Sep 2026.

08/2026 "A Veneer of Reconciliation? Youth Peacebuilding in the Shadow of Sri Lanka's Victor's Peace", ISA South Asia Conference, Colombo (Sri Lanka), 6 Aug 2026.

07/2026 Participant, WS AB: "Self-Determination in an Era of Democratic Shifts: New Directions in the Study of Secession, Autonomy and Minority Protection", 13th European Workshops in International Studies, Izmir University of Economics, Turkey, 1–3 July 2026.

2026 "The Authoritarian Settlement Playbook: Learning and Conflict Management in Turkey", Kurdish Studies Conference, London School of Economics, London (UK), 29 Apr–1 May 2026.

2025 "Evaluating Early Warning Systems in Policy-Driven Crises", IPSA World Congress, Seoul (South Korea).

2025 "Earning, Allocating, Providing: The Financial and Budget Management of the DAANES", 2nd International Kurdish Studies Conference, LSE, London (UK).

2025 "A House Divided Against Itself? Ideology, Trust, and the Limits of Kurdish Cooperation in the Syrian Civil War", 4th International Kurdish Studies Conference, University of Kurdistan Hewler, Hewler (Iraq).

2025 "The Gaza Crisis and the Limitations of Predictive Systems in Protracted Conflict", Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Kent (UK).

2025 "The Failure of Israeli Early Warning on October 7: What Lies Behind It?", SISP Conference, Università Federico II, Naples (Italy).

2024 "Syrian Kurdish Alliance Politics: Examining the PYD–KNC Wartime Negotiations Through a Multi-Actor Lens", SISP Conference, University of Trieste (Italy).

2024 "From Rebellion to Realpolitik: The JVP's Role in Post-Conflict Sri Lanka", Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Edinburgh (UK).

2024 "A Community Reimagined: The Sri Lanka Muslim Congress and the Shaping of Muslim Identity", Maydan–SeSaMO Conference, Sapienza University of Rome (Italy).

2023 "Beyond the Battlefield: Alliance Formation and Governance Strategies in the Syrian Civil War", SISP Conference, University of Genoa (Italy).

2023 "Displacement in the Shadow of Conflict: The Case of Shaqlawa's Christians in the Kurdistan Region of Iraq", Conflict Research Society Conference, King's College London (UK).

2023 "Alliance Formation and Rebel Co-Governance in North-East Syria: The Case of the PYD and the Syriac Union Party", ECPR General Conference, Charles University, Prague (Czechia).

Policy & Public Writing

2025 "The Paradox of Syria's New Peace". *The Loop* (ECPR).

2024 "AI and the Erosion of Humanity". *Groundviews*.

2024 "The JVP and Ethnic Relations: Walking a Tightrope to 2024" (Parts 1–3). *Groundviews*.

Languages

Italian Native speaker.

English C2 CEFR.

Turkish B1 CEFR.